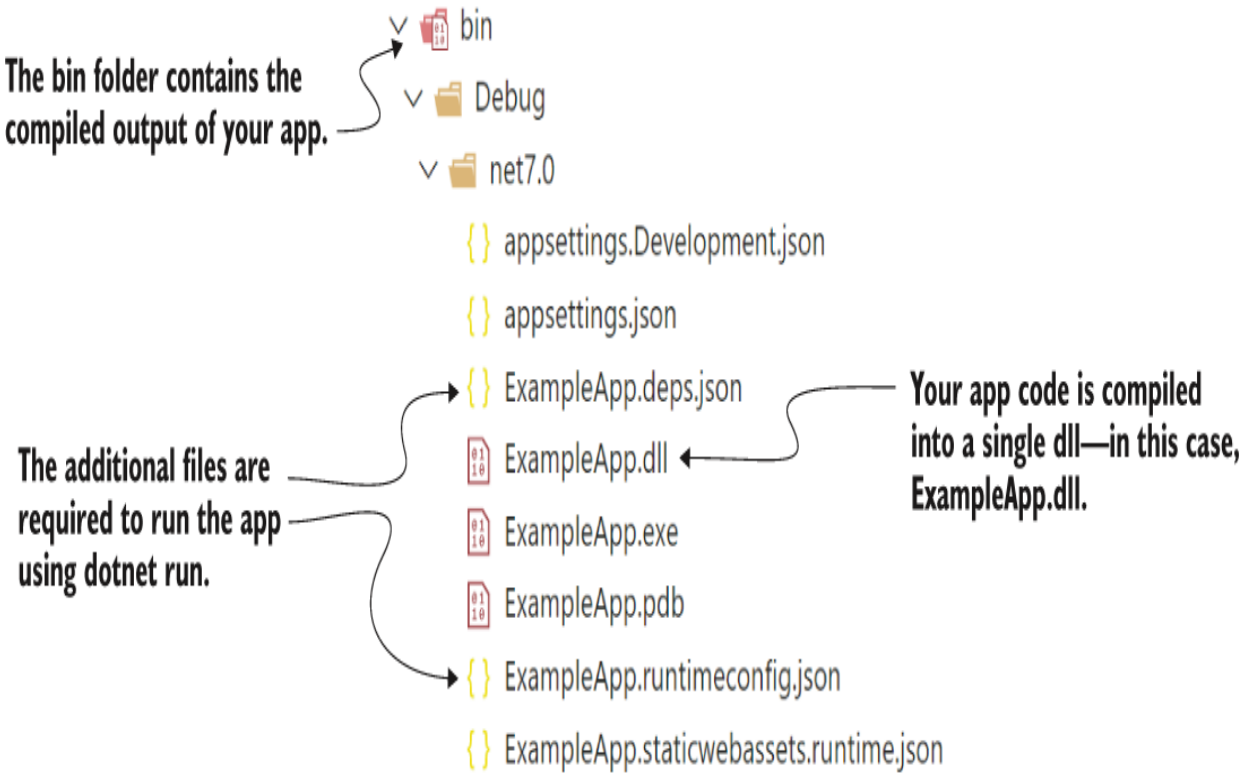


Figure 27.2 The bin folder for an ASP.NET Core app after running `dotnet build`. The application is compiled into a single .dll file, ExampleApp.dll.

NOTE In Windows you also have an executable .exe file, ExampleApp.exe. This is a simple wrapper file for convenience that makes it easier to run the application contained in ExampleApp.dll.

When you call `dotnet run` in your project folder (or run your application using Visual Studio), the .NET CLI uses the .dll to run your application. But this file doesn't contain everything you need to deploy your app.

To host and deploy your app on a server, you first need to *publish* it. You can publish your ASP.NET Core app from the command line using the `dotnet publish` command, which builds and packages everything